

Board 1

East Deals

None Vul

♠ Q 8 3
 ♥ 6 4 3
 ♦ 10 8 7 3
 ♣ 6 5 3

♠ J 7 6

♥ 10 5 2

♦ A J 9 4

♣ K 10 2



♠ K 5 2

♥ A 9 8

♦ K 5 2

♣ J 9 8 7

♠ A 10 9 4

♥ K Q J 7

♦ Q 6

♣ A Q 4

SOUTH has 18 points, a doubleton in the opponent's suit, and at least three cards in the unbid suits. This is an ideal hand for a Takeout Double.

NORTH has good strength in EAST's ♦ suit, probably two stoppers. He has 9 points and no 4-card suit of his own. This is the type of hand to respond 1NT.

SOUTH is happy to play Notrump now that she knows the ♦ s are covered, so she bids 3NT.

West	North	East	South
		1 ♦	Dbl
Pass	1NT	Pass	3NT
All Pass			
3NT by North			
Lead: ♥9			

Board 2

West Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 10 7 5
 ♥ K 10 7 6
 ♦ 10 9 2
 ♣ A 5 4

♠ A K 9 6 4
 ♥ Q 5
 ♦ K 7 4
 ♣ J 10 7



♠ J 3 2
 ♥ 8 4 3
 ♦ Q 8 5 3
 ♣ K 6 2

♠ Q 8
 ♥ A J 9 2
 ♦ A J 6
 ♣ Q 9 8 3

West	North	East	South
1 ♥	1 ♠	Pass	2NT
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			
3NT by South			
Lead: ♣5			

NORTH has an opening hand, 14 points and five ♠s. But WEST beat him to the punch, so he overcalls 1 ♠.

SOUTH also has 14 points, she doesn't care too much for ♠s, but she has an excellent stopper in ♥s. She jumps to 2NT, inviting NORTH to bid game.

Since NORTH has several points more than he might have had, and no 6-card ♠ suit to rebid, he happily bids 3NT.

Board 3

West Deals

None Vul

♠ J 10 5 4

♥ 6 4

♦ J 10 7 6

♣ 10 7 5

♠ 8 7

♥ K Q 9 7

♦ A K 8 3

♣ Q J 4



♠ K Q 6 2

♥ A 8 2

♦ 9 4 2

♣ 9 3 2

♠ A 9 3

♥ J 10 5 3

♦ Q 5

♣ A K 8 6

NORTH has 15 points and all the requirements for a Takeout Double of 1♠.

With 14 points of his own, SOUTH knows his side needs to be in a game somewhere. He passes this information to NORTH with a cue-bid of 2♠.

NORTH gets the message and starts the hunt for a trump fit by bidding 3♥. That makes it easy for SOUTH - he bids 4♥.

West

1♠

Pass

All Pass

4♥ by North

Lead: ♠K

North

Dbl

3♥

East

Pass

Pass

South

2♠

4♥

Board 4

East Deals

None Vul

♠ 8 3
 ♥ Q J 10 4
 ♦ A 9 4
 ♣ K Q 10 5

♠ K 7 5
 ♥ 8 5 2
 ♦ K Q 3
 ♣ 9 7 6 2



♠ 10 9
 ♥ K 9 6 3
 ♦ 10 8 6 5
 ♣ J 4 3

♠ A Q J 6 4 2
 ♥ A 7
 ♦ J 7 2
 ♣ A 8

There is only one reason that SOUTH should not overcall with 1 ♠. He is too strong. The maximum strength of an overcall is 16 points. Above that you should double.

So SOUTH doubles, and after NORTH bids 2 ♣, SOUTH bids 2 ♠. This shows an overcall type hand, but with 17 or more points.

NORTH has fine trump support and 8 points so she bids a confident 4 ♠.

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
		1 ♥	Dbl
Pass	2 ♣	Pass	2 ♠
Pass	4 ♠		
All Pass			
4 ♠ by South			
Lead: ♥ Q			

Board 5

West Deals

None Vul

♠ A 7 6
 ♥ Q 8 5
 ♦ A 9 3 2
 ♣ 10 9 4

♠ K 9 8 3

♥ 7 6

♦ K Q 5

♣ A J 7 6



♠ 10 5 4

♥ J 10 9 2

♦ J 10 8 6

♣ 5 3

♠ Q J 2

♥ A K 4 3

♦ 7 4

♣ K Q 8 2

NORTH has 13 points but has no bid over 1♦.

SOUTH can make a Takeout Double, so he does.

NORTH now cue-bids ♦ to show opening hand strength.

SOUTH shows his ♥ suit, NORTH doesn't like it.

NORTH shows her ♠ suit, SOUTH doesn't like it.

SOUTH shows his ♣ suit, NORTH likes it fine, but decides 3NT will be easier than 5♣.

West	North	East	South
1♦	Pass	Pass	Dbl
Pass	2♦	Pass	2♥
Pass	2♠	Pass	3♣
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			
3NT by North			
Lead: ♦ J			

Board 6

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ A J 10 7 4

♥ A 7 3

♦ A 8 6

♣ 9 5

♠ Q 5 3

♥ 9 8 4

♦ 10 3 2

♣ A J 7 4



♠ 9 6

♥ Q 6 5

♦ J 7 5 4

♣ K 10 6 2

♠ K 8 2

♥ K J 10 2

♦ K Q 9

♣ Q 8 3

WEST would have had a great opening 1♠ bid. But when SOUTH opened 1♠ in front of him he was hornswaggled. He couldn't bid any other suit, he couldn't bid 1NT and he sure couldn't bid ♠s. So he must pass.

And so does everybody else pass.

*West**North**East**South*

1♠

All Pass

1♠ by South

Lead: ♣9